

Chapter 12 – PIN and Account Security Management

12.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) has implemented several security measures to protect taxpayer information and ensure that only authorized users can access the **IRD e-Services Portal**. These measures include the use of a **Personal Identification Number (PIN)**, **Staff Identification Number (SSID)** passwords, account lockout mechanisms, password management procedures, and secure login practices.

Taxpayers are responsible for safeguarding their PINs and passwords and following the security recommendations issued by the Inland Revenue Department. Failure to do so may result in unauthorized access or temporary suspension of access to e-Services.

12.2 Importance of PIN Security

The Personal Identification Number (PIN) serves as the primary authentication credential for accessing IRD e-Services.

Proper PIN management helps to:

- Protect taxpayer information.
- Prevent unauthorized access.
- Secure online tax transactions.
- Maintain the confidentiality of tax records.
- Ensure compliance with IRD security requirements.

Taxpayers should treat their PIN as confidential information and avoid sharing it with any unauthorized person.

12.3 System-Generated PIN

When a taxpayer requests a PIN, the Inland Revenue Department issues a **system-generated PIN**.

The PIN is sent to the taxpayer through an official **PIN Mailer**, which is delivered to the taxpayer's registered postal address. If the PIN is requested in person at an IRD office, the taxpayer receives the PIN Mailer in a sealed envelope.

12.4 First-Time Login Security

When logging in with a newly issued system-generated PIN for the first time, the IRD e-Services Portal requires the taxpayer to change the PIN before any other services can be accessed.

This mandatory PIN change is a security measure designed to ensure that only the taxpayer knows the active PIN.

The taxpayer cannot continue using the portal until a new PIN has been successfully created.

12.5 Creating a New PIN

When changing the system-generated PIN:

- The new PIN must satisfy the system's minimum security requirements.
- The newly created PIN replaces the system-generated PIN immediately.
- The new PIN becomes the only valid PIN for future logins.

After the PIN has been changed, taxpayers should store it securely and use only the new PIN for future access to IRD e-Services.

12.6 Multiple PIN Requests

Taxpayers should avoid submitting multiple PIN requests.

Each new PIN request results in:

- Generation of a completely new PIN.
- Issuance of a new PIN Mailer.
- Immediate invalidation of all previously issued PINs.

Only the latest PIN issued by the Inland Revenue Department remains valid. Taxpayers should therefore wait for the most recent PIN Mailer before attempting to log in.

12.7 Forgotten or Lost PIN

If a taxpayer forgets the current PIN, a replacement PIN must be obtained.

A new PIN may be requested by:

- Submitting a PIN request through the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Visiting the nearest Inland Revenue Department office.

Once a replacement PIN has been issued, all earlier PINs become invalid.

12.8 Staff ID (SSID) Password Security

Companies and registered tax agents that use **Staff Identification Numbers (SSID)** must also manage SSID passwords securely.

Important requirements include:

- The initial system-generated password must be changed during the first login.
 - Companies or tax agents are responsible for managing SSID passwords.
 - The Inland Revenue Department does not reset SSID passwords on behalf of companies.
 - Password changes can be completed through the IRD e-Services Portal.
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12.9 Account Lockout

The IRD e-Services Portal includes an account lockout mechanism to prevent unauthorized access.

An account is automatically locked after **five consecutive incorrect login attempts** involving an incorrect TIN/PIN or SSID/password combination.

If the account becomes locked:

- The taxpayer should avoid making further login attempts using incorrect credentials.
- A new PIN may need to be requested if the current PIN cannot be remembered.
- SSID password issues should be resolved by the company or registered tax agent through the e-Services Portal.

12.10 Browser Security and Login Issues

The IRD recommends the following practices when using the e-Services Portal:

- Log out after completing all activities.
- Clear the browser cache if unexpected errors occur.
- Close all browser windows before logging in again.
- Use only **one browser tab** when accessing the IRD e-Services Portal, as multiple tabs may cause system errors.
- Use a supported web browser for the best experience.

12.11 Recommended Security Practices

To protect taxpayer accounts, the Inland Revenue Department recommends that taxpayers:

- Do not share their PIN with anyone.
- Keep the PIN confidential.
- Change the PIN periodically (approximately every six months).
- Store the PIN securely.
- Log out after completing online activities.
- Verify login credentials before attempting to sign in.
- Keep registered contact details up to date.

Following these practices helps reduce the risk of unauthorized access to taxpayer accounts.

12.12 Common Security Issues

Issue	Cause	Recommended Action
Forgotten PIN	PIN cannot be remembered	Request a new PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal or visit an IRD office.

Multiple PIN Requests	Several PIN requests submitted before receiving the previous PIN	Wait for the latest PIN Mailer and use only the newest PIN.
Account Locked	Five incorrect login attempts	Follow the IRD PIN recovery procedure or request a new PIN if necessary.
SSID Password Forgotten	Password lost by company staff	The company or registered tax agent should reset the password through the e-Services Portal.
Browser Error	Multiple browser tabs or cached information	Log out, clear the browser cache, close all browser windows, and try again using a single browser tab.

12.13 Frequently Asked Questions

Can I continue using my old PIN after requesting a new one?

No. Every new PIN request automatically invalidates all previously issued PINs. Only the latest PIN remains valid.

How often should I change my PIN?

The IRD recommends changing the PIN periodically, approximately once every six months, to

improve account security.

What happens if I enter the wrong PIN several times?

The account will be locked after five consecutive incorrect login attempts.

Can the IRD reset an SSID password?

No. SSID passwords must be managed by the company or registered tax agent through the IRD e-Services Portal.

12.14 Key Points

- The PIN is the primary security credential for accessing IRD e-Services.
- A system-generated PIN must be changed during the first login.
- Every new PIN request invalidates all previous PINs.
- Accounts are automatically locked after five incorrect login attempts.
- Companies are responsible for managing SSID passwords.
- Taxpayers should protect their PIN, change it periodically, and follow IRD security recommendations to maintain secure access to their tax records.